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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP(HONOURS),MGU-B.VOC(HONOURS)
REGULAR/IMPROVEMENT/REAPPEARANCE EXAMINATION APRIL 2026
SECOND SEMESTER
Multi-Disciplinary Courses (MDC) - MG2MDCENG101 - SPORTS LITERATURE AND CINEMA
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 1 Hour 30 Minutes **Maximum Marks: 50**

Scheme of Valuation

Part A - MCQ
Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark

1) b) Because it occurs in a temporary, distinct space [U] / [CO1]
2) b) Sports can inspire courage and unconventional choices in life [A] / [CO2]
3) b) To add emotional weight to key moments [U] / [CO3]
4) c) 2002 Commonwealth Games [K] / [CO3]
5) a) The team celebrates with Mandela on the field [K] / [CO3]

PART B – Short Answer
Answer any 6. Each question carries 5 marks

6) *Playing it My Way*: Ramakant Achrekar, Sachin's first formal coach at Shivaji Park laid the foundation of his cricketing journey - followed a strict and disciplined training routine - made Sachin practice for long hours every day with both morning and evening sessions - used innovative motivational methods - like the one-rupee coin challenge, where Sachin had to avoid getting out to earn a reward - worked on Sachin's mental strength - encouraging confidence, concentration, and a strong mindset under pressure -recognized Sachin's raw talent early. [U] / [CO1]

7) *The Chess Players*: The aristocracy of Lucknow is shown as decayed from within - rulers and nobles prioritize pleasure over responsibility - the Nawab of Awadh, Wajid Ali Shah, is weak and detached, focused on music, poetry, and luxury instead of governance - Mirza Sajjad Ali and Mir Roshan Ali are obsessed with chess and ignore real-world crises - their friendship turns into conflict over a trivial issue - a society lacking discipline and responsibility – the fall of Awadh is due to both British power and internal decay. [E] / [CO2]

8) *The Chess Players:* Societies collapse not only due to external threats but also due to internal apathy – the obsession of Mirza and Mir Roshan Ali with chess - the weak leadership of the Nawab reflects ineffective governance where leaders prioritise image, luxury, or personal interests over public welfare - the indifference of aristocrats toward the British takeover reflects social apathy - the danger of escapism, where excessive detachment into personal worlds leads to neglect of real responsibilities - modern ego clashes also contribute to social decline. [An] / [CO2]

9) *Lagaan*: The village of Champaner - both colonially oppressed and internally divided by caste – Kachra, a disabled man from the "untouchable" caste, is initially rejected from the cricket team - Bhuvan includes him based on skill, not caste - cricket becomes a symbolic space of meritocracy where caste barriers are temporarily broken - inclusion is gradual - Kachra is accepted mainly for his usefulness, not full equality - the film suggests that anti-

colonial unity requires confronting caste hierarchy, but also shows that caste is not easily erased. [An] / [CO3]

10) *Godha*: Wrestling becomes a space where individual ambition clashes with family pressure, gender norms, and community expectations - Aditi Singh faces patriarchal control from her brother but pursues wrestling with her father's support - Aanjaneya Das struggles between personal freedom and his father/coach's expectations - both characters grow through sport - society gradually accepts them as their talent becomes visible and successful. [U] / [CO3]

11) *Chak de India*: The team in *Chak De! India* consists of 16 players from different regions – players form state-based cliques, leading to regional bias and mistrust - North-East players like Mary Ralte and Molly Zimik face discrimination and isolation - some players mock or stereotype teammates - lack of trust affects passing and coordination - coach Kabir Khan enforces discipline and pushes them to focus on national unity over regional identity. [U] / [CO3]

12) Similar points as under Qn 10. *Chak de India* also deals with some similar concerns. [An] / [CO3]

13) *Godha*: Hanuman represents immense strength mirroring the power and endurance required in wrestling - the wrestling culture in the film's Kerala village treats Hanuman as an ideal figure for wrestlers – the image represents the values required in the sport, endurance, focus, and resilience – Aditi shows determination, fearlessness, and discipline. [K] / [CO3]

14) Film *83*: Use of real archival footage **-** integrates actual television clips and photographs from the 1983 World Cup - the recreated cricket matches closely match real match footage in camera angles, crowd reactions, and commentary style and broadcast presentation - vintage colour grading, older broadcast aesthetics, and period - accurate stadium visuals to recreate the 1980s atmosphere - India's victory over West Indies in the final is recreated. [A] / [CO3]

[5x6 = 30]

PART C – Essay
Answer any 1 question. Each question carries 15 marks

15) The autobiography *Playing It My Way* is engaging, authentic, and inspirational for readers. Anecdotes and personal stories humanize the sports legend by showing struggles, failures, and growth - demonstrate that mastery comes through discipline, practice, and resilience rather than natural talent alone - sacrifices involved in balancing training and personal life - failures and challenges become learning opportunities - Some anecdotes: Shivaji Park entry where Ajit drags 11-yr-old Sachin to Achrekar's camp -one-rupee coin drill, the advice of Achrekar to Sachin about joining Shardashram for better result. [E] / [CO1]

16) *Higuita*: title reference to the former Colombian football goalkeeper known for his highly unconventional and risky style of play. N S Madhavan critiques societal norms and expectations through Father Geevarghese and his admiration for the Colombian goalkeeper René Higuita - Father Geevarghese, a priest in Delhi, saves a vulnerable migrant woman (Lucy) who is threatened by a man (Jabbar)- Father Geevarghese steps beyond the traditional passive role of a priest and confronts the wrongdoer directly - challenges conventional ideas about religion, morality, courage, and social responsibility - Society expects priests to remain detached and passive - Father identifies with the daring style used by René Higuita who has played as an unconventional goalkeeper who leaves his post to join the game - the priest intervenes to protect the weak - heroism as moral courage, compassion, and action against injustice despite personal risk.

[An] / [CO2]

17) During apartheid in South Africa, rugby was racially divided - black players were not allowed to play with white players - even after some reforms in the late 1970s, inequality continued - Rugby team, the Springboks were seen as a symbol of white South African identity - Nelson Mandela envisions sport, especially rugby, as a tool to heal a deeply divided post-apartheid nation - Mandela supports the previously hated national rugby team, the Springboks, as a symbol of unity - encourages the team captain François Pienaar - Rugby becomes a metaphor for reconciliation - Mandela wears the Springbok jersey and cap during the 1995 Rugby World Cup final - Mandela celebrates with the players after South Africa's victory in the final. [An] / [CO3]

[15x1 = 15]